

1. INTRODUCTION

Phishing emails are one of the most common ways criminals steal information from businesses and individuals. These emails are designed to look like they come from trusted companies, such as banks, government agencies, or well-known services.

This report analyzes a real phishing email sample that impersonates a major US bank. It identifies all warning signs and provides clear guidelines to help employees and users avoid falling victim to these attacks.

2. EMAIL SAMPLE ANALYZED

Detail	Information
Sender Display Name	Chase Online Service
Actual Sender Email	merciayanmact@hotmail.com
Sent Via	Hotmail
Subject	Account Suspension Notice
Date Received	September 19, 2023
Target	Chase customers

3. CLASSIFICATION

Classification	Result
Email Status	PHISHING
Risk Level	HIGH

4. EMAIL BODY

Dear Customer,

Due to unusual activities on your account, we placed a temporary suspension until you verify your account.

What You Need To Do In Order To Restore Your Account.

To verify your account, Click on "Reactivate Your Account" below and complete the steps to verify recent account activity.

[Reactivate Your Account](#)

Sincerely,

Chase Online Service

5. PHISHING INDICATORS FOUND

1	Sender Email Does Not Match the Claimed Identity	Risk level = High
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The email claims to be from "Chase Online Service" a major US bank.

However the actual sender email address is merciayanmact@hotmail.com.

Chase Bank would never send official communications from a personal Hotmail account.

De: Chase <no.reply.alerts@chase.com> <info-yagcgyuze@boonsupply.com>

Enviado: terça-feira, 19 de setembro de 2023 10:58

Para: phishing@pot <merciayanmact@hotmail.com>

Assunto: Your Bank Account has been blocked due to unusual activities CASE# T53-H32-C10-C83

❖ Impact

Any employee or customer who trusts the display name without checking the actual email address could hand over their banking credentials.

2	Generic Greeting (No Real Name Used)	Risk level = High
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The email starts with "Dear Customer" instead of addressing the recipient by their real name. Real banks always use the customer's registered name in official communications.

❖ Impact

Any official bank email that does not use your real name should immediately raise suspicion and be reported.

3	Fear and Urgency Tactics	Risk level = High
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Creating fear of losing account access is a classic phishing technique.

When people are worried about losing access to their money or account, they act quickly without thinking or checking carefully.

❖ Impact

Employees who receive urgent account suspension warnings may panic and click the link without verifying whether the email is genuine.

4	Suspicious Malicious Link	Risk level = High
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The "Reactivate Your Account" button links to:

<https://dsgo.to/CQECQECnpqY3NDSGtODt9ft2qtxzcXGUveTV5fRYmtYAZsQ...>

This is clearly NOT a Chase Bank website. The real Chase Bank website is chase.com. This link uses a URL shortener to hide the real destination a classic trick used to disguise malicious websites.

❖ **Impact**

Clicking this link would take the victim to a fake Chase Bank login page designed to steal their username, password, and potentially card details.

6. HOW THIS ATTACK WORKS

Step 1: Criminal creates a fake Chase Bank login page that looks identical to the real website.

Step 2: Criminal sends thousands of emails pretending to be Chase Bank, warning customers their account has been suspended.

Step 3: Worried customer panics and clicks the "Reactivate Your Account" button in the email.

Step 4: Customer lands on the fake Chase login page and types in their username and password.

Step 5: Criminal captures the login details instantly and uses them to log into the real Chase account.

Result: The victim's bank account is compromised. The criminal can transfer money, change account details, or steal personal information.

7. PREVENTION GUIDELINES FOR USERS

What To Do

- Always check the sender's full email address not just the display name
- When your bank sends an alert, log in by typing the bank's address directly in your browser.
- never click email links.
- Report suspicious emails to your IT or security team immediately

Contact your bank directly using the number on your card to verify

- Look for generic greetings like "Dear Customer" real banks use your name

What NOT To Do

- Do NOT click "Reactivate", "Verify" or "Restore" links in emails
- Do NOT enter your banking password on a site you reached via email
- Do NOT trust an email just because it uses an official-looking logo
- Do NOT ignore account suspension warnings — verify them through official channels instead
- Do NOT assume an email is safe because it passed spam filters

Tool used

1. thunderbird eml viwer
2. browser dev tool

CONCLUSION

This email is a well-crafted phishing attack targeting Chase Bank customers.

It uses four high-risk techniques a spoofed sender identity, a generic greeting, urgent fear-based language, and a hidden malicious link to trick victims into handing over their banking credentials.